

The Road Ahead

EVERY ASPECT OF OUR LIVES HAVE BEEN DEEPLY AFFECTED BY THE ONGOING PANDEMIC and the general consensus is that this is now the new normal, at least till a vaccine passes all the trials and enters mass production. We've all normalised working from home and the whole world has adapted to this style of work but not all businesses can afford to operate this way. A lot of the consumer-facing businesses need that inflow of consumers to their physical premise, so they cannot easily transition to the WFH model without significantly rethinking the model. A good segment of the society relies on these businesses returning to normal in order to continue putting food on the table. Things have to get back to normal sooner rather than later. This would be the new normal.

At Digit we had a fairly simple transition, or at least it seems that way in hindsight. The online work could continue with little hindrance but there was no way we could get the magazine to you guys in the physical form that you love and cherish. We did quickly build a digital portal for the e-magazine and tried to get the experience as similar to the real thing but we still couldn't please some of you and we totally understand if you're irked by that. So it gives the Edit Team a lot of pleasure to finally print the June Anniversary issue and get it out to you. We don't know about you guys but not having a physical edition of the Anniversary issue would certainly have been a major disappointment for us.

That being said, we understand that quite a few might still be reading this in a digital format because your local newsstand couldn't open up owing to the lockdown measures. We still have the option for you to subscribe or purchase an individual issue to get the physical copies on our website. We'd also like to add that the Anniversary and Special issues tend to run out quickly.

Coming back to the new normal. Our gadgets are set to get a bit more expensive as volumes drop and folks focus on getting more products they need rather than what they aspire to own. This has a lot of implications on how quickly we'll

see international launches come to Indian shores and how much manufacturers will be willing to allocate for India. However, there's also a silver lining in the fact that more manufacturers are looking towards India to host their production facilities. And locally produced products will attract lesser taxes and we might see a change in adoption accordingly. Apple products, which are owned by few might see greater adoption because Apple is looking to shift some of their production from China to India. Apple is also getting one of their vendors, Pegatron, to bolster their Indian facilities. While few might have heard about Pegatron, it's one of the largest manufacturing companies in the world. They make computers, components, handhelds, consoles, GPUs, motherboards and a lot more. While Pegatron will only be moving their Apple production lines into the country, there certainly is potential for the other facilities to expand in India as well. That translates to more jobs in the manufacturing sector for India and our economy gets a nice boost thanks to the increased exports.

The new normal could end up being good for us in the long run or this is all just my naivety forming castles in the air. I'd always like my PC components to be cheap and accessible.

We also have exciting news to share about SKOAR! Hint: It's something Robert wrote about a couple of months ago that has finally come to fruition. Read his column to get all the details. [d](#)



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